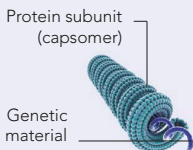


VIRUS SHAPES

There are thousands of different types of virus, with various shapes, such as balls, boxes, polygons, sausages, golfballs, spirals, and even tiny "space rockets". Viruses are classified by their size, shape, and symmetry as well as by the disease or groups of diseases they cause. Some, such as the complex virus known as the T4 bacteriophage, attack human pathogenic bacteria.

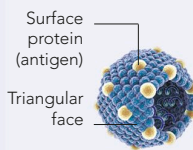
Spiral (helical)

The protein coat is corkscrew-like, with the genetic material entwined. Examples include myxoviruses and paramyxoviruses.



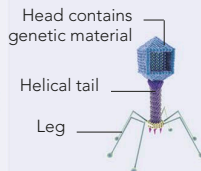
Icosahedral

Twenty equal-sided triangles connect to form a faceted container. Examples include adenoviruses and herpes viruses.



Complex

Complex viruses resemble a tiny rocket with "landing legs" that settle onto the surface of the host cell. They only attack bacteria.



5 BUDDING VIRUS

The nucleic acid (RNA) strands and protein-coat subunits join to form new virus particles. These form buds in the host cell membrane, using part of the membrane as their outer protective envelope.

